

ThrottleUp

for moto creators and ADV riders - and what the research says about how to pitch it

"VIN scan, recall alerts, multi-bike. Earn from maintenance content you already make."

You replied, thank you. This is the long-form companion to the email. It walks through what the research says about face-on-camera vs faceless content, then breaks down which path fits your creator archetype.

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1. App + business in 60 seconds

ThrottleUp is an iOS + Android app for motorcycle maintenance tracking. VIN scanner pulls from NHTSA vPIC. Recall integration runs against NHTSA Recalls API. Service intervals per bike, push reminders. Multi-bike for 2+ bikes. Maintenance log + photo, PDF / CSV export, anonymous public trip-sharing with privacy-cropped routes.

Why it sells

Market is empty. RIDEOLGY has 2.2 stars. Most riders track in Word doc or not at all.

Free vs Premium

- Free: 1 bike, 1 riding group up to 4, unlimited entries, VIN decode, recall lookup, PDF/CSV.
- Premium (3.99 USD/m or 24.99 USD/y): unlimited bikes, larger groups.
- Free Lifetime Premium for onboarded affiliates.

2. UGC vs faceless - what the research says

Face-on-camera content (UGC) converts higher than faceless content on average. Faceless still works - just differently.

Two findings from peer-reviewed influencer-marketing research are worth knowing. First, Sokolova and Kefi (2020) showed that parasocial interaction - the sense that a creator is a friend you happen to know through your phone - is a strong driver of purchase intent on Instagram and YouTube. Parasocial trust builds fastest when audiences see a face, hear a voice, and watch a person make choices. Second, Lou and Yuan (2019) found that perceived creator credibility (trustworthiness, expertise, attractiveness) directly increases consumer trust in branded content; creator visibility is one of the strongest credibility signals. Industry data from the Influencer Marketing Hub annual benchmarks consistently puts face-on-camera Reels and TikToks at higher engagement than pure screen-recordings, though the gap varies a lot by niche.

The caveat

Faceless has real strengths. When the demonstration is self-explanatory - a tool doing the thing, a satisfying B-roll, a screen-recording that compresses a 20-minute task into 30 seconds - the product replaces the personality. Faceless also scales: lower production cost per post, no on-camera nerves, easier to outsource. The cost is parasocial trust, which means lower conversion per view but often higher reach.

When each path works

UGC fits when face-on-camera is your credibility asset (you, your craft, your daily reality), when trust matters more than reach, and when you'd naturally say "I personally use this". Faceless fits when the demonstration carries itself (product on screen does the work), when you want to scale output, when on-camera isn't an option, or when you post under a brand persona rather than a personal one.

Sources

- Sokolova, K., & Kefi, H. (2020). Instagram and YouTube bloggers promote it, why should I buy? How credibility and parasocial interaction influence purchase intentions. *Journal of Retailing and Consumer Services*, 53, 101742.
- Lou, C., & Yuan, S. (2019). Influencer marketing: How message value and credibility affect consumer trust of branded content on social media. *Journal of Interactive Advertising*, 19(1), 58-73.
- Influencer Marketing Hub. (2024). *The State of Influencer Marketing Benchmark Report 2024*.
- HypeAuditor. (2024). *State of Influencer Marketing Report*.

3. Creator types - which path fits you

For moto, authenticity is the conversion multiplier - performative or stock-style content converts near zero, a real wrencher with a real bike converts at multiples of platform average.

Creator type	Primary path	Best hook angles	Realistic conversion
ADV / touring vlogger	UGC strong	VIN scan on your actual bike; recall alert mid-trip; multi-bike garage tour; maintenance log at 50k miles	3-5%, ADV audience trusts other ADV riders
Garage / wrench vlogger	UGC + Faceless mix	Oil change with reminder fire; valve check tutorial; maintenance receipt photo workflow; PDF export at resale	2-4%, wrencher trust is high
Build-thread / custom-builder	UGC + Faceless mix	Maintenance doc during build; VIN decode reveals; recall lookup on parts bike	2-3%, audience converts on proof-of-care
Cafe-racer / restomod	UGC	Vintage VIN decode; recall on a 2002 SV650; restomod log carry-over	2-4%, vintage audience values documentation
MotoVlogger (helmet-cam)	UGC + screen-rec mix	Pre-ride checklist with app reminder; recall alert mid-ride break; multi-bike workflow	1.5-3%, larger audiences but lower per-view
Faceless oil-change / how-to TikTok	Faceless	Silent oil-change tutorial with maintenance-log moment; VIN scan demo top-down; recall lookup time-lapse	1-2% per view, high posting cadence

4. UGC strategy (you on camera)

Who this fits

You with your bike. Garage-vlogger in your actual workshop. ADV rider on your actual tour. Wrencher with your actual hands oily. Audience tells within 2 seconds whether you own and ride the bike. Sokolova and Kefi (2020) parasocial trust applies double-strength here.

Hook examples that work

- "This VIN scanner just told me about a recall on my 2019 Tracer" - phone in hand at the bike, real reaction.
- "Why I stopped tracking my maintenance in Word" - talking head in the garage.
- "50,000 miles on this bike - here's the maintenance log" - PDF reveal, milestone reel.
- "My multi-bike garage walkthrough" - slow pan across 3-4 bikes.
- "Recall just dropped on my second bike - found out from the app first" - push notification screenshot.
- "Oil change Saturday" - full process, app reminder firing at start, log entry at end.
- "Bought this bike with no service history - here's how I'm rebuilding the log" - restoration storyline.
- "Selling this bike with 80,000 miles of documented care" - resale PDF reveal.

Format templates

- Garage vlog 60-90s: setup -> app demo -> wrench work.
- Talking head in workshop 30s.
- Ride-day vlog: helmet-cam -> pre-ride checklist app moment -> ride.
- Build-thread carousel: 8-10 IG slides with maintenance-log screenshots.
- Restoration storyline: multi-post arc.
- Milestone retro: "5 years with this bike".

Do / Don't

- Do: film in your actual garage.
- Do: name your bike specifically.
- Do: include boring moments - wrench work has waiting time.
- Don't: read marketing copy.
- Don't: stage perfect shots.
- Don't: promise NHTSA covers all manufacturers - it's US-focused.

5. Faceless strategy (screen-rec, voiceover, B-roll)

Who this fits

Hands-only POV. Top-down workshop angle. Voiceover-only walkthroughs. Many of the most-watched moto-maintenance creators on YouTube and TikTok are face-rarely, hands-frequently.

Hook examples that work

- Silent VIN-scan demo - top-down phone scanning a VIN tag.
- Oil-change tutorial 60s - hands only.
- Time-lapse: full service Saturday in 90 seconds.
- Recall-lookup demo - silent screen-rec.
- PDF export reveal - top-down on phone screen.
- Comparison: Word-doc-vs-app split-screen.
- Garage tour B-roll - slow pan, hands-only interactions.
- Build-thread chronology - month-by-month log time-lapse.

Format templates

- Hands-only POV 60s.
- Top-down phone screen-rec 30s.
- Voiceover-only tutorial: bike + hands on screen.
- Tutorial carousel: 6-8 IG slides.
- Time-lapse: full service compressed.
- Brand-channel: consistent overhead angle.

Do / Don't

- Do: caption every step.
- Do: real bikes only.
- Do: link in caption + bio.
- Do: keep ambient garage sound (impact gun, exhaust).
- Don't: unfocused trending audio.
- Don't: skip the actual work shot.

6. Audience fit

Works well for

- ADV / touring vloggers.
- Garage-vlog channels.
- Build-thread Instagram pages.
- Cafe-racer / custom-builder accounts.
- Oil-change / maintenance tutorial creators.
- MotoVloggers (larger audiences but harder to convert).

Works poorly for

- Sportbike-stunt content.
- Lifestyle moto-aesthetic without actual riding.
- Non-rider creators.

7. Posting cadence + best times

Moto: Saturday morning 9-11h local + Tuesday evening 19-21h local. ADV: any day, ride-day content peaks.
MotoVloggers: Sunday evening recap. 1 reel per week. Build-thread content posts in arcs.

8. Conversion math (why this pays)

50% rev share, 24 months. Premium 3.99 USD/m or 24.99 USD/y. ADV micro (40k followers): 25,000 views x 2% CTR = 500 clicks, 35% install = 175 installs, 6% Premium = 11 subs, ~140 USD per reel. Garage-vlog mid-tier (80k YouTube): 30,000 views x 3% CTR = 900 clicks, 30% install = 270 installs, 7% Premium = 19 subs, ~240 USD per video. Build-thread macro (200k IG, 6-post arc): 600,000 reach x 1% CTR = 6,000 clicks, 25% install = 1,500 installs, 5% Premium = 75 subs, ~940 USD. Moto subs renew at unusually high rates.

9. Tracking summary (full walkthrough in the Extended Brief)

Your link [throttleup.app/i/\[yourhandle\]](https://throttleup.app/i/[yourhandle]) works on every platform. Android uses Google install-referrer (deterministic). iOS warm uses Universal Link (deterministic). iOS cold (~99% of creator traffic) uses our DIY signed-token clipboard deferred-deeplink, live-verified, no Branch.io. RevenueCat fires on Premium purchase and credits 50% of net revenue to your handle for 24 months from each user's first paid month. 30-day refund holdback before payout becomes claimable. Full walkthrough is in the Extended Brief PDF.

10. Onboarding (5 minutes)

- Click the personal link from Mail 2 (valid 7 days).
- Land on [throttleup.app/affiliate/\[your-token\]](https://throttleup.app/affiliate/[your-token]).
- Fill in: handle, Wise payout details, country (for tax docs), billing address.
- Get your personal tracking link by mail + dashboard unlock.
- Free Lifetime Premium activation. No posting obligation, no expiry.

11. Dashboard (what you see)

- Live at getklar.org/dashboard (magic-link login).
- Per day / week / month: clicks, installs split (Android / iOS warm / iOS cold), active Premium subs in your bucket.
- Claimable EUR + paid EUR + next payout date.
- Refund-holdback pipeline + per-app earnings funnel.

12. Brand assets (download)

Logo, app screenshots, VIN-scan demo footage, garage workflow B-roll, colour palette and ready-made captions: getklar.org/i/throttleup/brand-assets.

13. FAQ

Does NHTSA cover European bikes?

vPIC and Recalls is US-focused. European riders benefit from VIN decode (works for most majors) but recall data is US-centric. Check national agency for EU-specific recalls.

What about Android?

Built and tested but paused at RC Android key step. Your link works for Android - waitlist page. Attribution retroactive when relaunched.

Non-English videos?

Yes. App is English-only but affiliate audience is global. German garage-vlog, French ADV, Italian cafe-racer all welcome.

Flat fee?

Moto channels are smaller but command higher per-view rates because of niche-trust. Mid-tier 150-500 USD, macros 500-1500 USD.

Trip-sharing feature?

In the app but in beta. Don't lead with it in marketing yet - focus on VIN scan, recall alerts, multi-bike.

Disclosure?

Yes. Moto audiences forgive honest disclosure but punish hidden ads.

14. One last thing

Honest read: ThrottleUp fits creators with a real bike, real garage, real maintenance content. If you're a lifestyle moto-aesthetic account that doesn't wrench, this is not a fit. Audience detects performance and your credibility takes the hit. We'd rather have 10 well-fit wrenchers than 100 random posts. Reply to Mail 2 either way.

On posts with affiliate link: #ad / #sponsored / Paid Partnership (FTC, EU disclosure law).